

7 Network plans

Including all the fancy features, the fact remains that your mobile is still a device with which you can make and receive calls, and what good is a mobile without a network plan that suits your need. With the options available in the market, it can be a daunting task to find a plan of your choice.

We will be giving a general overview of what to expect from each kind of plan, as the details are very volatile and vary across network operators, but also based on geographical location within one operator.

In the jungle of the options, your first task to find the correct path, is to decide between postpaid and prepaid.

7.1 Postpaid plans

Once you enroll for a postpaid plan, you can use the services (GPRS, SMS, and voice) as much as you want till you hit your credit limit (which in itself is very flexible) and at the end of your month you receive a bill. It is very analogous to your electricity connection, where there is no initial set limit on the usage, and at the end of your billing cycle you are presented with a bill.

These kinds of plans save you from the hassle of refuelling your network connections with top-ups and recharges, and at the end of the billing cycle you just have to pay a bill, which can be paid via several options, and most conveniently can be set to auto pay via your credit/debit card over the internet.

From the above, it is clear that while using this plan it is advisable to maintain self control as there is no set limit on your usage and if you don't exercise precaution, you can end up with a bill in which your total dues are astronomically high.

Most plans come in a format where you have to pay a fixed monthly rental plus for the services you use during the billing cycle. At the risk of massive generalisation, generally call rates are cheaper in a post

paid plan due to the initial rental. As a rule of thumb, if you are spending more than Rs. 800 a month on your prepaid vouchers then a research into your network provider's postpaid plan can usually result in more economical option.

If you are aiming for getting reimbursements via your company, college, school or any other organisation, it is advisable to go with a postpaid plan as you



A Trump (prepaid service of MTNL) recharge voucher